

Nate Bent

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July 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a network and systems engineer with over four years of hands-on experience designing, implementing, and supporting complex IT infrastructures across a diverse client base, from K-12 school districts to large private-sector organizations. I am writing to express my interest in senior network engineering opportunities where I can apply my technical depth, client-facing experience, and track record of owning technical delivery end to end.

My work at United Systems, LLC has given me broad exposure to enterprise-grade networking, security, and systems engineering. I regularly architect multi-vendor campus network solutions leveraging Cisco, Aruba, Fortinet, and Juniper Mist platforms, and I serve as the lead escalation point for complex switching, routing, and access issues across the organization's client portfolio. Beyond day-to-day engineering, I have coordinated large-scale infrastructure deployments involving multiple vendors and stakeholders, managing timelines, communicating risk, and ensuring minimal disruption to end users.

I have developed particular depth in network security and PKI, including designing and troubleshooting 802.1X/EAP authentication environments, managing certificate authority hierarchies, and integrating RADIUS platforms such as Aruba ClearPass into enterprise access control frameworks. I complement this hands-on engineering with automation skills, writing Python and Ansible tooling that streamlines infrastructure management, configuration deployment, and system provisioning while reducing manual effort and improving consistency across managed environments.

In my free time, I enjoy exploring new technologies and finding opportunities to apply them. Currently, I am working on implementing local agentic AI to help further automate portions of my day-to-day life. When I am not in front of a computer, I enjoy reading, hiking, and going to the gym.

I thrive in environments that reward technical ownership, continuous improvement, and clear communication. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background aligns with your team's needs.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Network and systems engineer with 4+ years of experience owning the design, implementation, and support of enterprise IT infrastructure across 75+ managed client environments, from K-12 districts with thousands of endpoints to mid-market enterprises. Lead escalation engineer for complex routing, switching, wireless, and firewall issues, with deep FortiGate NGFW expertise complemented by multi-vendor campus networking across Aruba, Cisco, and Juniper Mist. Skilled in PKI and certificate lifecycle management, 802.1X/EAP access control, and infrastructure automation with Python and Ansible. Holds multiple active certifications across Fortinet, Aruba, Juniper, and CompTIA product lines, and maintains a production-grade personal lab (Proxmox, BGP EVPN/VXLAN, NetBox, Terraform) documented at NateBent.com.

CERTIFICATIONS

- | | |
|---|---|
| ✓ Fortinet Certified Professional - Secure Networking | ✓ Fortinet NSE 4 - FortiOS Administrator |
| ✓ Fortinet NSE 5 - FortiManager Administrator | ✓ HPE Aruba Networking Certified Professional - Campus Access Architect |
| ✓ HPE Aruba Certified Professional - Campus Access | ✓ HPE Aruba Networking Certified Network Security Professional |
| ✓ Juniper JNCIS - Mist AI Wireless (JN0-452) | ✓ CompTIA Network+ |

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Competencies

Networking: BGP, OSPF, VXLAN/EVPN, policy-based routing, VLANs, 802.1Q trunking, STP/RSTP, LACP/MLAG, multicast/IGMP, QoS, campus LAN/WAN design, dynamic routing migration

Firewall & Network Security: NGFW policy architecture and lifecycle management, threat protection (IPS, application control, web and DNS filtering, SSL deep inspection), IPsec site-to-site and SSL/remote-access VPN (FortiClient/FortiEMS), SD-WAN, HA clustering, and centralized management via FortiManager.

Wireless: Enterprise WLAN design, large-scale AP deployment and migration, cloud-managed and controller-based architectures

Access Control & PKI: 802.1X/EAP (PEAP, EAP-TLS), RADIUS NAC, SIEM / log analytics, PKI/CA hierarchy design, certificate lifecycle management, SCEP/NDES, OSCP, security incident response

Automation & Scripting: Python, Ansible, Bash, PowerShell; API integrations, configuration management, infrastructure tooling

Vendors & Platforms

Networking: Cisco (IOS/IOS-XE), Aruba (AOS-S, AOS-CX), Fortinet (FortiGate, FortiManager), Juniper Mist

Security: Fortinet FortiGate NGFW, FortiClient/FortiEMS, Aruba ClearPass

Wireless: Aruba Central, Aruba AOS 8 (Mobility Conductor/Gateway), Juniper Mist AI

Virtualization: Microsoft Hyper-V, VMware ESXi, Proxmox VE

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network Engineer | [United Systems, LLC](#) - Oklahoma City, OK

April 2022 - Present

United Systems is an IT managed services provider serving a diverse client base including K-12 school districts, healthcare organizations, and mid-market private-sector companies. As a Network Engineer, I own technical delivery across the full project and support lifecycle.

- Architect and implement multi-vendor campus network solutions across Cisco, Aruba, Fortinet, and Juniper Mist platforms for a client base of 75+ organizations, ranging from small businesses to large school districts with thousands of endpoints.

- Serve as the primary escalation engineer for switching, routing, wireless, firewall, and server issues; diagnose and resolve complex infrastructure problems under time pressure with clear client communication throughout.
- Design, deploy, and tune FortiGate NGFW security across client environments, including firewall policy frameworks, IPS, application control, web and DNS filtering, network segmentation, and IPsec site-to-site and remote-access (FortiClient/FortiEMS) VPNs.
- Manage PKI environments including Windows Server CA hierarchies, certificate template configuration, SCEP/NDES enrollment for mobile devices and Chromebooks, OSCP responder setup, and CRL maintenance.
- Identify and implement automation opportunities across infrastructure management workflows, building Python and Ansible tooling for tasks such as API-driven configuration management, bulk migrations, and multi-host provisioning to reduce manual effort and improve repeatability.
- Own infrastructure projects end-to-end across multiple vendors and internal teams, from scoping and design through deployment and ongoing support, managing scheduling and stakeholder communication while translating technical concepts for non-technical clients.
- Perform firmware lifecycle management and security patching across managed network and server environments, including HA failover upgrades and rollback planning.
- Respond to and remediate security incidents, rapidly identifying root causes and implementing corrective controls to restore service and keep client environments running.
- Implement and support VoIP infrastructure including Cisco CUBE session border controllers, SIP trunk configuration, and dial-plan design across multi-site environments.
- Lead ESXi to Hyper-V migrations utilizing both new and existing hardware, scoping each engagement to client requirements and designing migration paths that minimize downtime and preserve workload integrity.

NOTABLE PROJECTS & INITIATIVES

Large-Scale Wireless & Switching Refresh: Cloud Migration

- Led the migration of 1,500 access points from on-premises AOS 8 Mobility Conductors and Gateways to cloud-managed Aruba Central on AOS 10, refreshing legacy 320/530-series APs to 730-series hardware alongside a 250-switch AOS-CX upgrade, improving visibility and enabling remote zero-touch provisioning.
- Coordinated multi-phase deployment across dozens of sites, managing vendor logistics, cutover scheduling, and stakeholder communication to maintain continuous network availability throughout the transition.

Campus Network Refresh with Unified RADIUS Authentication

- Deployed and integrated a full wired and wireless replacement of 750 access points and 100 switches across a large district, displacing a mixed Dell EMC and Aerohive/Extreme environment with Aruba CX 6300/8000-series switching and Aruba Central-managed wireless.
- Unified all wired and wireless access under Aruba ClearPass for 802.1X RADIUS authentication, implementing certificate-based and credential-based EAP policies with dynamic VLAN assignment and consistent policy enforcement across 15,000+ managed and unmanaged endpoints.
- Stood up Windows PKI and deployed ClearPass Onboard to provision certificates across the full device range, from district-managed laptops and Chromebooks to BYOD phones and tablets.

District-Wide Migration to Fully Dynamic Routing

- Planned and executed the migration of a school district's multi-site WAN from static routing to a fully dynamic routing architecture, improving network convergence, resilience, and long-term operational simplicity.
- Designed the full routing topology, managed cutover sequencing across all sites, and validated reachability and failover behavior before and after transition with zero unplanned downtime.

Firewall Modernization Program: 50+ Client Replacements

- Delivered over 50 firewall replacement engagements, migrating clients from a wide range of legacy platforms to Fortinet FortiGate NGFWs, standardizing on a consistent security architecture with centralized policy management via FortiManager.
- Rebuilt complete NGFW configurations during each migration, including firewall policies, IPS, web and DNS filtering, and IPsec site-to-site and remote-access VPNs.
- Identified and implemented automation opportunities throughout the migration workflow, including policy conversion, DHCP scope migration, and post-cutover validation, significantly reducing per-project deployment time and manual effort.